

To the National Science Foundation and the Office of Science and Technology Policy,

Unchecked innovation risks consolidating power in the hands of a few, deepening inequality, and leaving millions of Americans behind. **Without strong, responsible oversight, this transformative technology could exacerbate our nation's challenges rather than elevate its potential.**

My name is Carissa Lintao, and I've spent my career at the intersection of technology and advertising, working with some of the most recognized brands and entrepreneurs in the world.

As the founder of Apptuitive, an industry-leading firm specializing in mobile growth, I have helped scale million-dollar companies and advised high-growth startups on how to build businesses that are both ethical and profitable. I've worked with Techstars, Inflection AI, and BD, and my insights on innovation have been featured in Forbes, TEDx, and major industry publications.

Beyond my work, my perspectives on innovation are rooted in how I learned to think. Being homeschooled demonstrated that powerful learning occurs in environments that cultivate critical thinking, autonomy, and the ability to see beyond the obvious. Mastery comes from sensing what others overlook, questioning assumptions, and adapting with precision in the face of uncertainty.

This philosophy shapes how I approach business and technology. True innovation goes beyond efficiency and scale—it's about making strategic, responsible choices that both push industries forward while creating lasting, profitable impact.

The truth behind my work: Responsible innovation reflects integrity and the potential for being the most profitable choice as well.

Beyond a technological breakthrough, AI is an economic force multiplier that will define America's global market position in the coming decade. When the United States leads AI, it will control trillions of dollars in economic value, making it a strategic priority for both business and national competitiveness.

However, without strategic oversight, AI risks being consolidated by a handful of large corporations, limiting its benefits to small businesses and emerging entrepreneurs. Our country must ensure that AI remains a catalyst for broad-based economic growth rather than a tool for market consolidation.

America has always met every challenge with strength. AI is our next great test. I trust this administration will make it a priority, and I stand ready to help shape the future. Let's not just "make America great" – let's keep it great.

Below are my recommendations for tackling the challenges we face.

1. AI Will Replace Jobs and America Must Be Ready

Sam Altman, CEO of OpenAI, predicts that **AI will eliminate 70-80% of current jobs—yet his company, and others in the space, fail to provide any roadmap for how workers will transition in an AI-driven economy.**

This existential challenge cannot be ignored.

The current reality:

More than half of Americans currently read below a sixth-grade level. ([APM Research Lab](#))

This directly means most of the workforce is not prepared for AI disruption, nor are business owners equipped with strategies for integrating AI while maintaining jobs or creating new ones.

Education and workforce training must evolve immediately, or else AI's reshaping of the economy will leave millions of Americans behind.

This concern impacts several areas: Education for children who represent future workers as well as issues for entrepreneurs, small business owners, and workers across countless industries. **AI literacy must become as fundamental as reading, writing, and arithmetic.**

Without a completely premeditated shift in our education system, our country will not keep up and will be left behind.

Recommendations:

National AI Literacy & Workforce Readiness Initiative

AI literacy is fragmented, with no universal standards. K-12 programs are not mandatory, community college AI courses are scarce, and workforce retraining is inconsistent. Small business owners lack access to AI education, leaving them at a competitive disadvantage.

Key Solutions

- **Integrate AI Literacy into Federal Education Funding** – Update Title IV-A grants to support AI curriculum & teacher training.
- **AI Teacher Training Nationwide** – Ensure every K-12 school has AI-ready educators.
- **Expand AI Workforce Programs** – Scale NSF-backed AI training for community colleges in all 50 states.
- **Establish a Standardized AI Literacy Framework** – Define essential AI skills across

education levels and industries.

- **Upskill Entrepreneurs & Workers** – Fund AI training for small business owners and workers.
- **Public-Private Workforce Transition Programs** – Develop real-world AI training with corporate partners.

Who Trains Them & What Is Their Training Criteria?

For the **National AI Literacy & Workforce Readiness Initiative** to be effective, AI educators and trainers must be equipped with the right expertise, frameworks, and methodologies. The success of this initiative depends on **who trains them, how they are trained, and what standards define AI literacy across different industries and education levels.**

Who Trains Them?

1. **AI Industry Experts & Researchers** – Professionals from leading AI organizations, universities, and research institutions who specialize in AI development, ethics, and applications.
2. **Certified Educators & STEM Trainers** – K-12 teachers, college professors, and vocational trainers who undergo AI-specific training programs to integrate AI education into standard curricula.
3. **Corporate AI Practitioners** – AI professionals from companies like OpenAI, Google, Microsoft, and IBM who provide real-world AI insights and applications.
4. **Public-Private Partnerships** – Government-backed AI training programs developed in collaboration with major corporations and education organizations to align workforce needs with AI skill development.
5. **NSF-Backed AI Training Programs** – Community college instructors and workforce trainers who receive funding and certification to provide AI training in local economies.

What Is Their Training Criteria?

To ensure AI literacy is standardized and effective, **a structured training framework must be established** to cover:

1. **Foundational AI Knowledge** – Understanding AI principles, machine learning basics, data ethics, and responsible AI use.
2. **AI in the Workforce** – How AI impacts different industries, automation trends, and strategies for workforce adaptation.
3. **AI Tools & Applications** – Training on commonly used AI platforms, automation tools, and decision-making systems.
4. **Hands-On AI Implementation** – Real-world projects and case studies to apply AI knowledge in business, education, and innovation.
5. **Continuous Learning & Certification** – AI literacy is constantly evolving, requiring ongoing training and certification to stay up to date.

By **training educators, entrepreneurs, and workers with a clear AI literacy framework**, this initiative ensures that AI becomes an **economic equalizer**—empowering businesses, students, and the workforce to **adapt, innovate, and compete.**

National AI Awareness & Skills Campaign

The federal government should spearhead a nationwide AI education campaign, as recommended by the National AI Advisory Committee (ai.gov). This “AI for All” initiative would provide:

- Free AI learning modules for students, workers, and entrepreneurs.
- Public education efforts through libraries, museums, and media.
- Online courses and community workshops demystifying AI.

My firm, Apptuitive, with its expertise in marketing, consumer engagement, and behavior-driven communication, understands how to bridge the AI knowledge gap effectively. We propose leading a National AI Literacy & Public Awareness Digital Campaign—ensuring small businesses, entrepreneurs, and workers have the practical knowledge and resources to navigate AI’s impact.

2. AI Becoming a Market Monopoly Poses a Both a National Security and Domestic Economic Threat

A handful of corporations control AI infrastructure, talent, and data—giving them unchecked power to dictate who benefits from AI and who gets locked out.

This consolidation poses severe risks:

- **Small businesses are excluded**, lacking access to critical AI technology.
- **Innovation is stifled**, as monopolies control who builds and at what scale.
- **National security is at risk**, with AI-driven decision-making concentrated in the hands of a few entities.

Compounding this issue, Big Tech platforms currently allow anonymous developers to operate unchecked.

This unchecked flood of unverified AI applications threatens consumer trust, national security, and U.S. innovation. Without safeguards, bad actors exploit systems. To maintain global AI leadership, the government must enforce stricter developer verification and accountability.

Recommendation:

- **Apple and Google must no longer allow anonymous AI developers to operate in the App Store.**

To ensure a competitive and secure AI ecosystem, the government must implement policies that promote responsibility.

3. AI Must Be Pro-Innovation, But That Means Solving Real Needs—Not Manufactured Ones

AI-driven businesses should solve real problems, not just create artificial demand through manipulation.

Currently, AI is being used to:

- Amplify consumer addiction loops rather than solve actual user needs.
- Drive hyper-personalized advertising, exploiting consumers without their informed consent.
- Replace human decision-making in ways that weaken rather than enhance intelligence.

Advertising illiteracy is a critical issue—most consumers do not understand how AI-driven advertising manipulates their behavior. AI should enhance the market. Instead, it manufactures demand by preying on consumer vulnerabilities.

Additionally, entrepreneurial leadership training is lacking. AI best drives true innovation when business leaders are effectively equipped to use it. Right now, most small business owners do not understand AI, most have still not adapted to social media, and there is little training available for them.

Recommendations:

- Ensure AI funding prioritizes solutions that solve real business and consumer needs—not just engagement-driven models.
- Increase AI literacy in business and advertising to prevent market manipulation at scale.
- Expand entrepreneurial leadership training programs to ensure business owners understand AI's role in their industries.

Without a responsible approach, AI risks becoming a tool for manufacturing demand rather than driving genuine, sustainable economic progress.

Together we can foster innovation that solves real problems, or accelerate consumer manipulation, short-term gratification, and economic inefficiencies.

If left unchecked, this cycle will not only erode market integrity but also deepen societal disengagement—**continuing to accelerate a diminishing sense of purpose—on an unprecedented scale.**

AI is reshaping our understanding of meaning itself. Choices are being made for consumers, their desires molded by prediction engines that are built for engagement, not fulfillment.

Creators are in no better shape. When AI can generate, automate, and optimize faster than creators can think, what's left to create? When everything is designed for attention, nothing is built for meaning in the present time.

This matters because attention and meaning are not the same currency. Attention is fleeting. Meaning is enduring.

The result? A world where both consumers and creators feel like cogs in a system they can't escape, questioning whether their work, their desires—even *their thoughts*—truly matter.

And here you are, sifting through, most likely, AI-generated insights, attempting to craft an action plan that doesn't just sound good — but *means* something.

The real answer to this AI plan of action isn't more efficiency — it's meaning.

That is our challenge.

4. Attracting and Retaining Top Talent Best Results From A Values-Driven Culture

As entrepreneurship and technology become more accessible, the competition for exceptional talent intensifies. The most skilled professionals are increasingly drawn to companies that prioritize and authentically live by their core values. When trust is compromised, employees are quick to "jump ship," leading to significant challenges in retention.

Recent studies highlight this trend:

- A 2024 WorkProud study found that only 23% of workers aged 42 years or younger expressed a strong interest in remaining with their current employers long term. This figure drops to 18% for workers aged 30 years or younger. [prnewswire.com]
- Research indicates that companies with a clear commitment to their values attract and retain top talent, benefiting from a motivated workforce. [forbes.com]

As barriers to entry in business continue to diminish—through advancements like AI, no-code solutions, and increased access to capital—the ability to build something is no longer the primary differentiator. The true competitive edge lies in attracting and retaining exceptional minds. The strongest players in this new landscape are those who are deeply self-aware and actively seek companies with aligned values. Skills can be taught, and capital can be raised, but a company's values—its core mission, treatment of people, and the culture it fosters—determine whether it attracts top-tier talent or repels it.

This underscores a fundamental truth: People make or break a company. The best entrepreneurs and executives have always understood this, but we are now entering an era where it is non-negotiable. Companies that thrive will be those that build environments of

trust, responsibility, and alignment—not just with customers, but with their own people.

In the past, companies could prioritize profit over people because employees had fewer alternatives. Compensation was the primary differentiator—if a company paid well, it could attract top talent, even with questionable culture or ethics.

But as AI becomes democratized and the playing field levels, that equation will shift. Right now, salaries in AI-driven industries are astronomical, but this won't last forever. As AI tools become more accessible and widespread, companies will no longer be able to compete purely on compensation. The gap will tighten. **The differentiating factor will shift from *who pays the most* to *who aligns with people's values the most*.**

At the same time, accountability will become more intense. As digital transparency increases and AI makes it easier to track and analyze corporate behaviors in real time, employees won't just question a company's values—they'll fear being associated with the wrong brand and group of people. We may reach a point where working for a company or government agency with "ethical blind spots" carries personal and professional risk. Theoretically speaking, a single AI-generated report exposing poor labor practices, environmental negligence, or biased decision-making could make an entire workforce radioactive.

This means companies can no longer afford to treat values as a PR exercise. The era of performative ethics is ending. The AI arms race will give way to a *values arms race*—one where companies and governments that genuinely align their technology and operations with trust, fairness, and integrity will attract and retain top talent, while those that cut ethical corners will struggle to attract the minds they seek.

The real competitive advantage won't just be in *having* AI but in *how* AI is used. Are we automating in ways that enhance human creativity, or just cutting costs? Is leadership transparent about how AI decisions are made? Are we using AI to build a future people actually *want* to be a part of?

Recommendations:

1. **Operationalize Core Values** – Move beyond slogans by embedding values into hiring, AI governance, and technology itself. Conduct regular audits to ensure leadership and teams uphold these values through real decisions, not just in messaging.
2. **Mandate Leadership Training & Accountability** – Require all leaders to complete decision-making training, participate in bias mitigation workshops, and be held accountable through a public-facing mechanism. Establish an AI ethics task force to prevent reputational risk. This ensures proactive AI transparency and responsible use.

By executing these steps, companies and governments secure trust, attract top talent, and maintain a competitive edge in an era where values define long-term success.

5. “Kind Innovator” – Incentivizing Ethical Leadership in AI

In 2018, I traveled to Washington, D.C., to meet Megan Smith, former United States Chief Technology Officer. We had a long conversation about technology and ethics, and at the end, she handed me a coin.

For me, this coin was not just a symbol—it was a call to action, selectively gifted to changemakers committed to using science, technology, and innovation to advance the well-being of the American people.

In that moment, she did not just hand me a coin—she handed me a profound sense of responsibility.

Seven years later, that responsibility remains at the core of everything I do.



The Problem: An Industry Without Guardrails

Today, the elephant in the room is our government struggling to navigate an AI-driven world where industry leaders operate like children in a candy store with limitless resources and no oversight.

The unchecked pursuit of profit has outpaced our ethical frameworks, leaving us at risk of irresponsible innovation that serves pockets, not people.

It is time for the U.S. government to set the standard for responsibility and accountability in AI. That starts at the top.

How do you incentivize good behavior in these “god amongst men” individuals when the “ultimate incentive” – money – is a seemingly infinite resource?

The answer?: Immortality.

The Solution: “Kind Innovator” – A New Standard for Leadership

The Kind Innovator program recognizes and incentivizes business leaders who embody America’s core values—integrity, responsibility, and ethical innovation.

Throughout history, we have admired and immortalized individuals like Abraham Lincoln, Martin Luther King Jr., and George Washington Carver—not just for their influence, but for their sacrifice and unwavering commitment to doing what’s right, even when they didn’t have to.

Everyone wants to be these leaders, but too few are willing to act like them.

Now, at the forefront of AI’s transformation, we need leaders willing to shape this new era—not just for profit, but for progress.

This is the program America needs to operate. It is time for the United States to take back the narrative—not that success alone makes you great, but that America makes you great.

Call to Action: A Government-Led Initiative to Set the Tone for AI’s Future

By elevating and rewarding responsible leadership, we can shift the incentive structure—making legacy, not just wealth, the true measure of success.

This program transcends ethics while being part of something far greater than oneself.

The greatest innovators and leaders don’t just want to accumulate wealth—they want to be remembered. They want their names engraved into history. Being recognized by America itself cements individual success and potentially solidifies their place in the nation’s legacy.

Kind Innovator offers a distinction reserved for those seeking to shape not just industries, but civilization itself. There would be strict criteria, ensuring that only the most forward-thinking, responsible, and visionary leaders earn their place among the architects of America’s AI-driven future.

Done right, this becomes the ultimate aspirational benchmark – from a young girl studying chemistry in 4th grade to the next industry titan—a mark of honor that money alone can’t buy.

Final Thought: AI Must Serve America’s Business and Workforce Interests

AI should not be a force that dictates the future—it should be a tool that empowers Americans

to build it. The true measure of AI's success will not be in how quickly it advances, but in how effectively it creates new opportunities, strengthens businesses, and elevates the American workforce.

To ensure that AI strengthens the U.S. economy, it must be positioned as:

- **A catalyst for economic expansion**—empowering businesses of all sizes to scale and innovate, rather than consolidating power within a select few corporations.
- **A driver of job creation**—enhancing workforce capabilities, fostering skill development, and creating new opportunities, rather than displacing workers without a clear path forward.
- **A strategic advantage for American businesses**—boosting productivity, increasing global competitiveness, and ensuring that the U.S. remains the leader in AI-driven industries.

This administration has a critical role in shaping the national perception of AI—not as an existential threat, but as an opportunity for all Americans to participate in and benefit from. AI should not be something that intimidates the public or widens the knowledge gap—it should be a tool for empowerment, economic mobility, and innovation.

This happens when Americans are equipped with the education and resources necessary to engage with AI meaningfully. This happens when this administration positions itself to positively act on its responsibility to position the American people for success. To elevate national literacy, foster entrepreneurial thinking, and provide clear pathways for workforce adaptation.

Our legacy cannot be conditional and limited based on half of us reading below a sixth-grade level. If this gap is not addressed, AI will not be an opportunity—it will be an insurmountable barrier.

This administration must choose: Shape AI into a force that uplifts our people and businesses, or allow it to widen economic and educational gaps that will leave millions behind.

This administration has the unique opportunity to set the entire tone for the personal and cultural perception of AI. Don't let "AI" overwhelm the American people. Use it to fuel a stronger economy, a skilled workforce, and a more prosperous future for all. Together we can make AI the next iteration of the ongoing American Dream.

Please consider my involvement – with my trusted partners – in the shaping of your AI policy going forward. Let's discuss at your earliest convenience.

Thank you for your time.

Carissa Lintao, CEO, Apptuitive

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